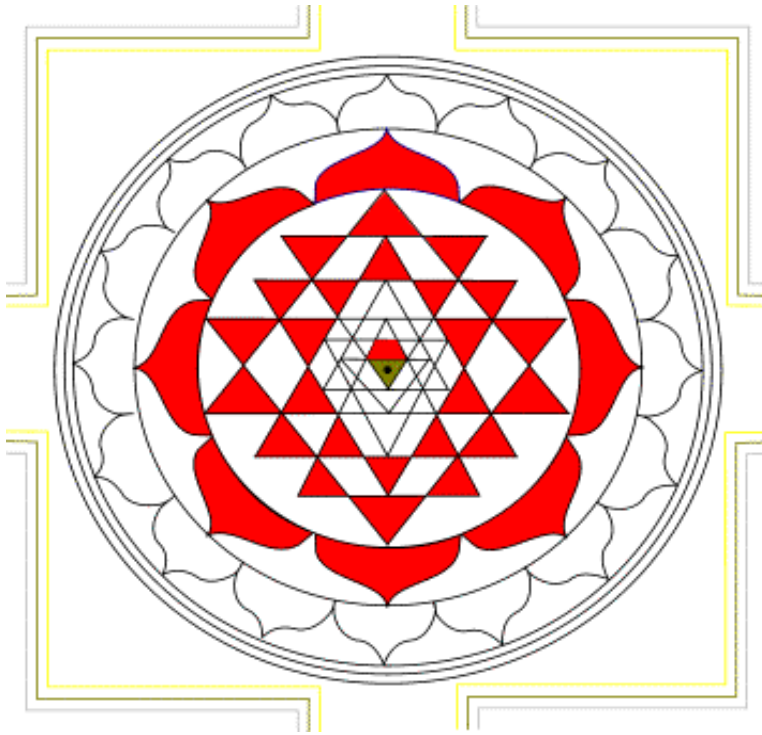




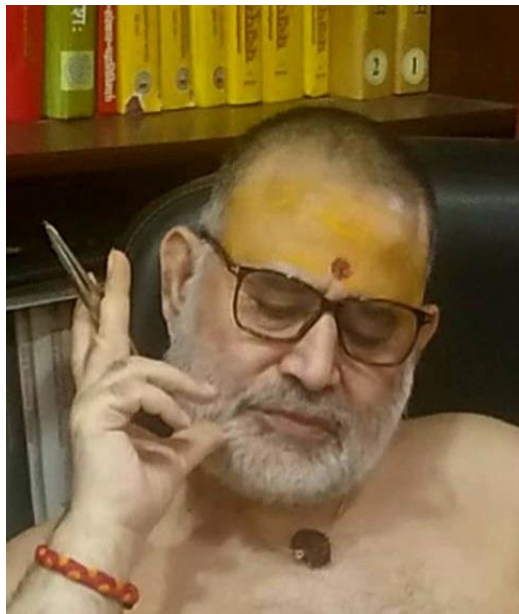
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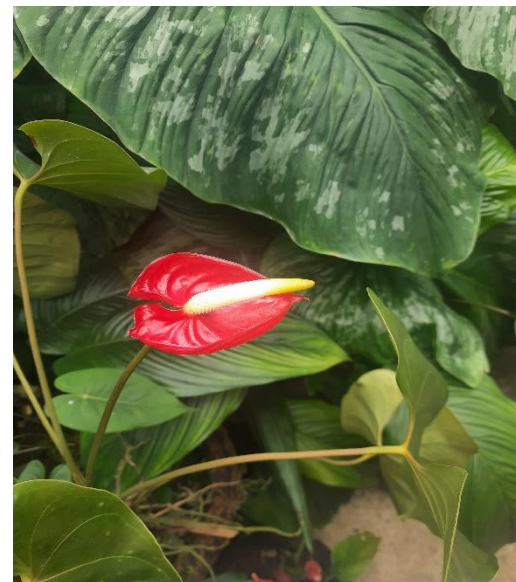
Jan-March 2024



From the Chief Editor's Desk

To see things in a seed is genius
Lao tzu

This axiom of a Chinese sage is called the maxim of fig tree in a seed वटधान्यकणिका



न्यायः in Sanskrit. .There are myriad imperfect and fragmented visions. A conditioned vision is fragmented and thus imperfect .firstly because of multiplicity of divergence and secondly due to a perpetuated reciprocation of aberrance . A unified perspective leads to an actualisation of a single universal substratum of the variegated

phenomena . Oriental seers realised and prophecied the significance of Advait or non dualism . The corollaries which provide allowance for this abstract realisation are the tantra and agamas . These off shoots of the main stream have their own commissions and omissions for retaining the usual course of behaviour actual or intellectual . Realisation of the absolute truth doesn't bring in any change in your course of life except that once enlightened you do not aspire for it anymore .

What's so special about an enlightened man asked an aspirant from his enlightened guru - can he levitate or do astral travelling ,telepathy clairvoyance , mind control or manipulation ? An enlightened being is only enlightened that's all .He doesn't pursue the illusory produces of neisance .

आत्मज्ञस्त्वात्ममात्रदृक्
नाविद्यामनुधावति।

Divergent drift and distraction have become a way of living these days. It is next to impossible for a common place man to withstand them and get introvert . Such maxims are postulated by the hoary seers to redeem aspirants who are inspired for subtler and substantial spiritual gains . Lao tzu's seeing things in a seed is merely an interpretation of his intuitive insight into a simpleton's language. .This process has a well defined and systematic lineage of mysticism that leads to the actualization of a single subjectively conscious universal substratum and various Tantra and Agamas have many such knacks .

An enlightened father instructs his unenlightened but erudite and therefore indolent son Shwetketu.

“this such a minuteness pervades the entire phenomena and is one with all that is* , this is the absolute truth the universal self. o!

shwetketu identify yourself with this .

*स य एषोणिमा एतदात्म्यमिगंसर्वं तत्सत्यम्।

Just as infinity refers to all three aspects viz time, space and substance minuteness also pertains to all these three aspects of the

universal phenomena. Time miniscule, the point of convergence of entire space, all pervasive ether as the sublemost gradation of substance are not three different entities in a parlance of total transcendence. This point or instant or matter of transcendence is the seed Lao Tzu is talking about. This seed is pregnant with entire penta dimensional universal phenomena with three time dimensions. Both minuteness as well as infinitude are relative notions and exist only when there is a third witness of both. From an absolute standpoint both are complimentary and are not different from their mutual substratum of subjective consciousness.

SwamiParanand Tirth

Founder president CEO

YTA yoga Tantra &Agama(inc)CAL USA

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Montreal Quebec CAN

Editorial



Journey of each individual soul is towards 'completion', a quest for an absolute state which everyone consciously or subconsciously aspires. Whether one acknowledges this primordial longing or chooses to look elsewhere, it very much stays there in the form of a dormant seed waiting eternally for the conducive environment. Giving the example of an acorn and an oak tree, Aristotle observes that given proper environment and condition an acorn will become an oak tree though it is not evident from its shape. An acorn contains the blue print of an oak tree and the ability to see oak in an acorn is generally termed as 'having a vision'. Visionaries are those who look at the same world as others but don't see the same thing. Their perception goes beyond the ordinary sense perception and penetrates the spirit and creates a holistic image. He/She is able to see connections and developments which cannot be grasped by intellect alone.

Worldly pleasures have a strong sense of attraction and an elusive promise of fulfillment. Seers and sages have seen this as a wonderful play of the divine. While some schools of thought advocate the path of complete abstinence and calling the bluff; others like Tantric schools acknowledge the game, respect it and play along with awareness. To enter this play with consciousness of self changes the entire dynamics and one is able to see things from a totally different perspective. Aspirants often pray

to devi to make them enjoy as well as transcend this universal play.

Explaining the notion we begin with the insightful editorial by our Guru Maharaj, Swami Paranand Tirth ji on the nature of Enlightenment. "Realisation of the absolute truth doesn't bring in any change in your course of life except that once enlightened you do not aspire for it anymore." writes Swamiji

Next we have translation and exposition of 8th verse of 'Neel Saraswati Stotram' from 'Brihanneel Tantra'. In this verse is explained how by worshipping Ma Tara one can attain physical as well as mental powers. A dunce can become an erudite scholar by unlocking the hidden potential which Ma points out to him.

Following this we have an interesting academic write-up by Bhoomi Sati on 'Yoga and Cognitive faculties'. Further we have a short write up on the concept of 'Ananda' which focuses on the connection between Devi worship and Philokalia suggesting that the love for beautiful is one of the most pleasant and potent paths to transcend this physical world while engaging in it.

It is followed by the translation and exposition on first karika from Ishwar Pratibhijna Karika by Utpaladeva from the YTA study circle. Next we have a brief write-up on 'The Science of Shakti' by Varni Paratpar Swarup quoting the verses from 'Shakti Vijnana' and their detailed exposition.

A brief insight into the online classes conducted by YTA is next which is followed by a passionate poem titled 'Swelling Skirt-Swirling River' by Prof Ambika Talwar, expressing the deep desire to become one with the source. The issue ends with a photo feature on Swamiji's recent visit to Kaziranga National Park in Assam.



(Kimiya)

NEEL SARASWATI STOTRAM

(A Hymn to the sapphire goddess of wisdom
from Brihanneel Tantra) Cont.



लक्ष्मीः सिद्धगणाश्च पादुकमुखाः सिद्धास्तथा वारिणां
स्तम्भश्चापि रणाङ्गणे गजघटास्तम्भस्तथा मोहनम्।
मातस्त्वत्पदसेवया खलु नृणां सिद्ध्यन्ति ते ते गुणाः
कान्तिः कान्ततरा भवेच्च महती मूढोऽपि वाचस्पतिः॥
८॥

Semiotic depictions of metaphysical
phenomen

O mother by adoring your feet one attains spiritual accomplishments like wealth , the powers of superhuman deities like paduk mukh, siddhas ganas ,he can stupefy enemy in the battlefield he can paralyse the trumpet of elephants or entice his opponents . your devotee looks as charming as a cupid and even a dunce becomes another vachaspati – virtuoso by worshiping you .

Yoga and Cognitive Faculties



Bhoomi Sati

Yoga involves the systematic cultivation of mental and physical well-being through the application of shatkarma, asana, pranayama, mudra, and meditation techniques. Numerous studies have explored the impact of Yoga on cognitive and psychological health indicators.

"Cognition" refers to the collective mental processes occurring in the brain, encompassing activities such as thinking, attention, language use, learning, memory, and perception. Rather than existing as isolated abilities, these processes form a complex interplay of different and interconnected skills. Together, they enable individuals to function effectively as mentally healthy adults. Cognitive scientists focus on various mental faculties, including language, perception, memory, attention, reasoning, and emotion. These aspects collectively contribute to the understanding of how the mind processes information, perceives the world, and engages in complex cognitive activities.

Yoga, an ancient science emphasizing disease prevention, treatment, and overall well-being, has demonstrated efficacy in mitigating the effects of aging and treating age-related disorders. This centuries-old discipline combines physical postures, rhythmic breathing, and meditation practices to provide practitioners with a holistic mind-body experience, promoting both physical and emotional well-being.

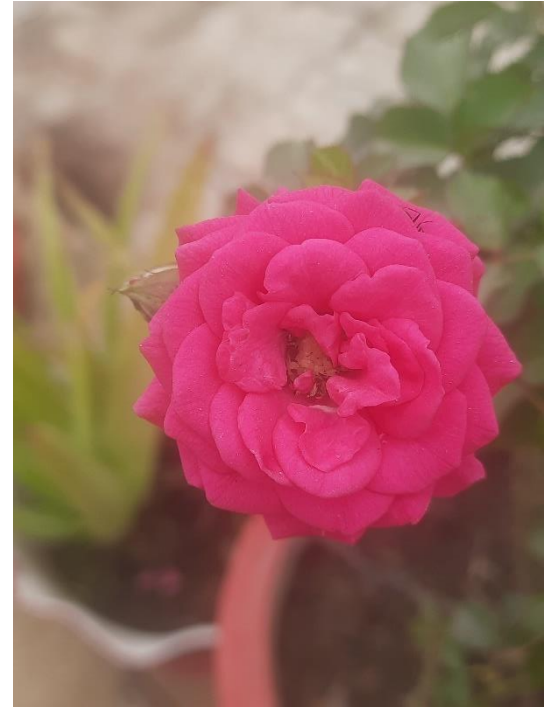
As a mind-body intervention, Yoga has the potential to improve overall intelligence and executive functions while also lowering anxiety levels in individuals. Yoga incorporates asana (postures), pranayama (breathing practices), and Dhyana (meditation), aiming to enhance the physical, psychological, and spiritual well-being of individuals. Research indicates that yoga practice led to a significant improvement in the Intelligence Quotient (IQ) of mentally challenged students. Another study involving middle-aged participants revealed a positive correlation between mindfulness, fostered through yoga and meditation, and fluid intelligence. Furthermore, the regular practice of yoga and meditation has been shown to slow down the decline in fluid intelligence over time.

Many individuals engage in yoga to enhance their overall health and prevent illness. The practice of yoga has been shown to elevate cognitive performance, psychosocial well-being, and happiness. A recent meta-analysis indicates that yoga significantly impacts various aspects of cognitive capacity in healthy individuals, including concentration and information processing, executive function, and memory. The study suggests that higher-intensity and integrated yoga practices are associated with greater health benefits. As yoga becomes more commercialized, these advantages are becoming increasingly evident to the general public. The enhancement of cognitive function through yoga is believed to occur through increased overall body awareness and attention, which may have a positive impact on cognition.

The relationship between yoga practise and brain shape and function was examined using a variety of brain imaging modalities, including MRI, fMRI, PET, and others, in a recent review. In most of these research, the brain structures of people who had practised yoga before and those who had not were compared. The results showed that yoga practitioners tended to have higher volumes in important brain areas, such as the hippocampus and frontal cortex. These areas are essential for mental processes including memory and learning. Furthermore, there was promising data suggesting that longer yoga practise sessions could be associated with larger volumes in particular brain regions, suggesting a possible cumulative effect over

time. In another study, participants with mild cognitive impairment were given instructions to practise yoga for a duration of 12 weeks. The participants' verbal memory had significantly improved, according to the results. The default mode network of the brain was discovered to have more connections in correlation with this improvement. Activation of the default mode network occurs while thinking, fantasising, and planning; these alterations indicate that yoga has a beneficial effect on cognitive function, especially memory in those with mild cognitive impairment.

Yoga appears to be a potential strategy to address health issues that arise now and in the future. With more medical professionals endorsing exercise over medication as a non-pharmacological treatment for mental health issues like anxiety and depression, yoga is clearly a strong candidate to be a part of this therapeutic strategy. Furthermore, yoga poses a great deal of promise for using, in conjunction with other behavioural therapies, as preventative measures against age-related and neurodegenerative diseases. Interestingly, the parts of the brain that yoga positively affects are the ones that are most vulnerable to atrophy brought on by ageing. Yoga is an exercise that people of all ages and backgrounds can and should embrace due to its significant advantages for the body, mind, and soul.



(Bachelor's in Psychology from Indraprastha College for Women, Delhi University. Currently pursuing Master's in Psychology specialising in Behavioural Neuroscience from Concordia University, Montreal.)



Ananda Mimamsa

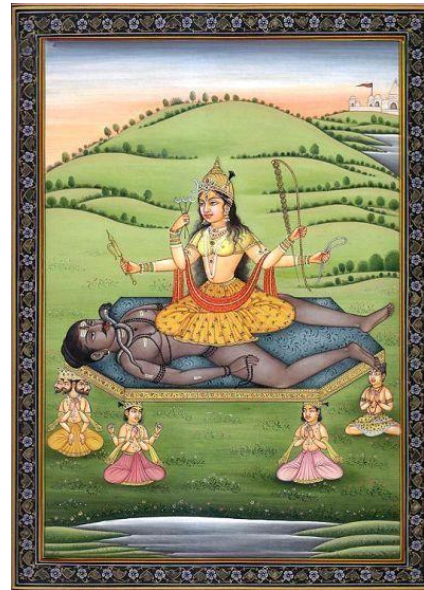
Experiencing to Becoming Ananda

The journey of self is an inward one, from experiencing Ananda to becoming Ananda i.e. from a dualistic experience to a non dualistic embodiment. The moment one starts to think about Ananda in a subjective manner, the dynamics changes drastically. It is not longer a quest into the pleasures and escape from the pain rather it epitomizes a completeness, a constant underlying all the changing phenomena. It goes beyond the mind and its dualistic tendencies which always posits high with low, pleasure with grief, happiness with sorrow and so on. The true brush with Ananda can give us a glimpse in the eternal and hence fill the souls with ultimate bliss dependent on no external cause.

Both in West and East sages and saints realized that no human effort could lead to this ultimate eternal feeling of bliss. The path was found through prayer and devotion, in cultivating a feeling of oneness in whatever one does and experiences. The idea was to locate beauty in everything and become one with it. Beauty can lead to emancipation. Experiencing beauty and incorporating what is beautiful was realized as a sure shot way of achieving divine bliss through a pleasing path, a path that lets you enjoy and detach at the same time.

Both eastern and western traditions have stressed on this. The path of devi worship which bestows ‘bhukti mukti artham’ on her devotees and Philokalia ‘love of beautiful’ which lets your soul transcend to heights unimaginable, both talk about this manner of worship. This idea was explored by Sri Shankaracharya in Saundarya Lahari “the Wave of Beauty”. It consists of two parts viz. Ananda Lahari meaning waves of happiness (first 41 stanzas) and Saundarya Lahari (the next 59 stanzas). Tradition suggests that Lord Ganesha himself has etched the Ananda Lahari on Mount Meru and it was read from there by Sage Gaudapada who taught it to Adi Sankara. Adi Sankara himself added the rest of the 59 stanzas and completed it. Devi Tripura Sundari manifests as a beautiful symbol of pure perception which unites the seer with the seen and also with the process of seeing, all becoming one. This encounter with absolute beauty generates ultimate bliss and hence the devotees of devi constantly live in a blissful state as the text states

“May all those who read this be drenched forever by this “Wave of happiness”



<https://in.pinterest.com/pin/566186984408840675/>

The idea is reflected in Maulana Rumi’s mystic verse

Khod kuza-o khod kuzagar-o khud gil-e-kuza, khod rind-e-sabookash, khod bar sar-e aan kuza khareedar bar aamad

(Himself the vessel, himself the potter and himself the mud of which the pot is made, himself the drinker and himself the buyer...)

The Philokalia (Ancient Greek: “love of the beautiful, the good”, from philia “love” and kallos “beauty”) is a

collection of texts written between the 4th and 15th centuries by spiritual masters of the Eastern Orthodox hesychast tradition. The collection was compiled in the eighteenth-century by St. Nikodemos of the Holy Mountain and St. Makarios of Corinth. These texts emphasize the importance of contemplative life and inward prayer in which the mind becomes absorbed in the awareness of God everywhere and in everything. In their introduction, the translators of the English version tell us the meaning of the Philokalia. ***“Philokalia itself means love of the beautiful, the exalted, the excellent, understood as the transcendent source of life and the revelation of Truth. It is through such love that, as the subtitle of the original edition puts it, ‘the intellect is purified, illumined and made perfect.’ . . .***

According to the authors of the English translation, Kallistos Ware, G. E. H. Palmer, and Philip Sherrard, the writings of The Philokalia have been chosen above others because they:

” ...show the way to awaken and develop attention and consciousness, to attain that state of watchfulness which is the hallmark of sanctity. They describe the conditions most effective for learning what their authors call the art of arts and the science of sciences, a learning which is not a matter of information or agility of mind but of a radical change of will and heart leading man towards the highest possibilities open to him, shaping and nourishing the unseen part of his being, and helping him to spiritual fulfilment and union with God.”

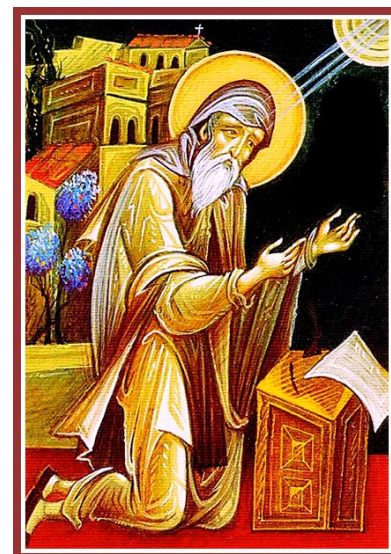
Nepsis, a key concept in Eastern Christian spirituality, signifies inner calm, lucidity of thought at the same time alertness and vigilance. St Hesychios links Nepsis with attentiveness, purity of heart and guarding of intellect

The second master theme is “hesychia, which is stillness or silence of the heart,” and is also the “shedding of thoughts,

The ultimate idea is to awaken in ‘Christ’s body’ and one’s realization of divine functioning through him or her.

“I move my hand, and wonderfully my hand becomes Christ, becomes all of him (for God is indivisibly

whole, seamless in his Godhood). I move my foot, and at once He appears like a flash of lightning. Do my words seem blasphemous? – Then open your heart to him. And let yourself receive the one who is opening to you so deeply.”



<https://westernmystics.wordpress.com/2015/04/20/philokalia/>

Ishwar Pratibhijna Karika

Karika :

कथंचिसाद्य परमेश्वरस्य दास्यंजनस्याप्युपकारमिच्छन्
समस्तसंपत्समवाप्तिहेतुतत्प्रत्यभिज्ञामुपपादयामि।

Translation:

Having attained the servitude of Maheshwara some how ,and with an intention of redeeming others too I propound the tenets of pratyabhijna doctrine which lead to accomplishment of all my affluences.

Exposition:

A karika is a sanskrit verse that gives the detailed exposition of a specific description in a nut shell .Pratyabhijna karika by Utpaldev the grand master of Abhinav guptacharya has been commented upon by himself .Later a detailed exposition was compiled by Abhinav gupta . After pratyabhijna hridayam these lessons from YTA yoga tantra and agama study circle [class room]are being prepared after a detailed study of IPK (Ishwar Pratyabhijna Karika) and IPV (Ishwar Pratyabhijna Vimarshini) and IPVV (Ishwar Pratyabhijna Vivrati Vimarshini) to facilitate comprehension and assimilation of this doctrine by our aspirants .

The propitiatory verse of IPK given above enunciates the prerequisite for entry into the school of Pratyabhijna i.e. servitude . which the author says is very difficult to attain .

The term Dasyam has a special etymological derivation – दीयते स्वामिनांयदभिलषिदमिति

दास्यम् swamina yadabhi lasitam iti dasyam

One who is bestowed upon by the master anything desired is a rasa or servile .

An intelligent devotee doesn't stop at any worldly accomplishment but wants the knowledge of his essential nature i.e. Maheshwara-then his grandeur follows automatically.

Docility and servile attitude are however conducive to this effect only. The virtue of Dasyam comes by adoring the holy feet of the guru who is not different from Parameshwara. This coincidence of serving a guru who has realized his essential nature as Shiva is also due to a special munificence of the lord. This

Dasyam is impeded by many obstacles so retaining this attitude till the end is how Abhinavagupta defines the term Asadya. Who so ever is born or is subject to the trail of death and birth is a Jana. After attaining the grandeur of Parameshwara en passant upon realizing him as one's essential nature the author of these cantos wants even those who are not competent enough, to be redeemed since the munificence of the lord and his embodiment the master (guru) is the only sine qua non. The aspirant is not required to be competent a-priori. All good things must be shared so Utpalacarya says that he is feeling guilty about confining this doctrine only to himself . So while intending to redeem another person so that by imparting this school of Pratyabhijna and by assimilating it he too attains the ultimate objective and in turn attains completion.

Questions

- A .Servitude or dasyam in this parlance refers to
- 1 . Rendering Manual service
 2. A docile and obsequious temperament
 3. The virtue through which the lord bestows everything
 4. A rite that qualifies an aspirant for seva.

B. Asadanam(आसादनम्) or attaining dasyam depends on

- 1 dexterity of the aspirant
- 2 munificence and compassion of the Guru
- 3 a firm commitment that prevents the aspirant from getting waylaid
- 4 .2 and 3.

C.

जनः Jana

1. Is a special devotee
2. Any sentient creature
3. Any one subject to the trail of death and birth
- 2 and 3.

D. All wealth

- 1.Is riches
- 2 is all that is upon this earth
- 3 is the grandeur of Parameshwara.
- 4 none of these

Pratyabhijna means

- 1.A sudden flash of understanding



2. An intuitive insight into the self leading to a direct experience of innate identification with one's essential nature .

3. The doctrine that establishes epiphany as a supra rational phenomena .

4. 1,2 & 3

The science of Shakti 3



<https://www.gallerypioneer.com/artists/gr-santosh~37>

Laksham or the objective . The fourth step towards the manipulation of spiritual awareness .

Despite their affiliation to some antique sect of purists many derivations which are either out of use or were never in rigour ,can be noticed in the works of ancient Kashmir shaivites . What would other wise be spelled out as लक्ष्यम् has been written as लक्षम् a synonym for hundred thousand. We have come across many such instances while studying IPVV where the illustrious author meticulously comes out with an etymological justification of such uncommon usage . Laksha trayam according to Maheshwar Abhinavgupta is not 3 million but the three points where the yogi must focus while performing the rite of purashcharanam (repeating a mantra as many times as the number of alphabet it contains) So laksham is the goal or the objective . After the yogi has pierced the cluster of nerves or nadis he must follow the course of a nadi which leads him to the goal or objective . Some what like driving the car out of your home into the main stream and then choosing the lane according to your

destination . Laksham or aim or to be more, precise aiming has three steps:

Prana's release and withholding ,visualising of the shakti of given description and visualising of kundalini in the anaahat kala in kanda . The semiotics of shakti has been given as two lines above and below the three fold spiral in the middle . The line above denotes the moon and the one below sun .while controlling or withholding the breath the shakti has to be visualised as effulgent as thousand suns .

This fourth step is exercised between the sacral and naval plexus where the awareness resides as a fraction of anahat kala . Some sects of yogis practice nadanusandhanam in this region instead of muladhara or anahat the main seat where visual perception are sublimated into tactile and audible one . Their symbol of great void and nada the eternal word called seli and Banshi in colloquial verbiage hangs well below their naval upto what has been called kanda chakra in Saivite canons . Kanda as we have already mentioned above is a cluster of various (72000)mystic conduits through which the vital airs circulate . These converge first into 72 then into 14 and finally into the three main passages . All kalas of the sun and the moon are present in the kand chakra and have been called anahat kala . Presumably anahat or cardiac plexus is an accumulation of 4+6+2 petal of Mula and swadhisthan so Manipur has ten petals, ten petal plus two comprise the twelve petals of the heart plexus . The kala anahat pervades all plexuses and acquires various descriptions in the four peethas . Viz kam in the muladhar purn in the Manipur ,Jalandhar in the ajna and shri in the crown of the head . the nada manifests in various forms in these regions and all yogins are required to familiarise with them . Somanand nath says anahat kala manifests in the kand or sacral region and is semiotically visualised as a spiral with two straight lines extending from both ends . This is more of tantric encryption than a symbol actualisation . For more such semiotic encryptions the reader can refer to vmakeshwari matam ,varivasyarahasyam or nitya shodashikarnav. These have various semiotic depictions of nada,nadant shakti vyapini,samani and unmani .



<https://www.gallerypioneer.com/artists/gr-santosh~37>

Anahat kala (a fraction of the total nada manifestation) as mentioned by somanand should be understood as a spiral I.e kundalini and upwards straight line denoting the moon and the one below denoting the sun . These are also mentioned in other agamas as urdhwa kundalini and adhah kundalini . The shakti in this region is as effulgence as thousands of suns and moons . Kumbhak vritti refers to holding the breath while meditating . An aspirant of this mystic process should hold his breath while visualising shakti in this region . We have enunciated the difference between imaginary-visualisation and recapitulation of a mystic experience shared by one's preceptor or first hand by the aspirant . From the perspective of yogi Pratyaksha -mystic perception of a yogi all such experiences are well defined and stand in no need of mental imagery

or doodle on the part of an aspirant . This part of the process has been named as lakshanam or specification . The next step is arousal of kundalini shakti .

उत्थापनम्

We came across one mudra -shakti utha pini mudra in some arcane cannon on tantricism . One interlocks all fingers with each hand back to back. After joining the tips of both index fingers hands are rotated so that the tips of both index fingers fingers can be made to touch the forehead .

शक्त्युत्थापिनीमुद्रया स्वदेहेशून्यतांविभावयेत् ।

While displaying this shakti utha pini mudra or the gesture of lifting the shakti the aspirant should meditate upon thee void within his body .*

Then the aspirant should meditate on the Kamakala which emanates from the gurus mouth .then he realized the entire creation as originating from the kam kala कालकलातमकंपरिणामंस्वगुरोर्मुखाग्निर्गतिविभायेत्।

According to this scripture the process of arising begins in the kanda . Brahmanand the commentator on Hathayoga says that kundalini **re lambs** entwined around Swayambhu lingam in the muladhara and blocks the opening of Susumna with her mouth with कफ and पित्तम् .This blockage is cleared by Bhasrika pranayama .In this process begins in the kanda or sacral region and kumbhaka or holding the breath precedes the “entry of the serpent power in the passage aided with nadanusandhanam or concentrating on the automatically resonate word of the Anahat which is also heard partially in the kanda . The two lines on either side of the spiral called kundalini also refer to the process of creation and dissolution where as the kundalini signifies sustenance .

To be cntd.

*Practitioners of “strenuous effort “

By

Varni Paratpar swarup

A brief insight in the online classes conducted by YTA

In the Yogtantragama Study Circle we read and discuss many arcane texts in the divine guidance of our Guru Maharaj Swami Paranand Tirth ji. Swamiji reads and explains the metaphysical import of these texts along with conventional commentaries.

Currently we are studying The Svachhandatanram with Commentary 'Udyota' by Ksemrajacarya and Yogini Hridaya Dipika of Amrtanandanatha. The former text is a highly esoteric text highlighting the worship of Svachchanda Bhairava and his consort Aghoreshvari and the latter an important text of Sri Vidya tradition.

Swamiji explains the cryptic sutras and expositions in a manner that we can grasp it better and go beyond the literal meaning.

In last few months we have completed the study of 'Viropaksha Panchasika', 'Siddha Siddhant Paddhati' and 'Hatha Yoga Pradipika'. Though the classes are in sanskrit with a little patience and self study one can immensely benefit from them. Anyone interested to join us may please request Swamiji for the link.



Swelling Skirt – Swirling River

~ Ambika Talwar



A river full and swollen swirls rapidly in mad waltz
toppling desire down the lane where not many walk.

River aches for a touch – her currents rise twirling,
soak skirts where raindrops play – river rushes on.

See twigs and stems thin and wiry make ripples
as river keeps swirling – colors become each other...

shades of blue transpose into green, maroon, yellow.

But your brown eyes intent with shadows of love

seek mine. What is it you wish to say, say it! Now, lest
my shoes run away in raging waves. See, I lost a shoe,

and my feet are madly wet. How shall I dance for you?

My heart's full and swollen, emptying into the river.

Walk me across this mad alliance of waters – Let them
not be tears. See, I twirl in my skirt – just like this.

River stops to take a cue, winks. And my rain-woven
dancing skirt drenched in the rain...is helpless – I am.

#

(Ambika Talwar is an India-born author, poet, wellness consultant, artist, and educator whose vision is to realize her sacred destiny and invite others to brilliance. She has authored *4 Stars and 25 Roses* (poems for her father) and *My Greece: Mirrors & Metamorphoses* about her travels through Greece in 2002.)



Photo Feature: Glimpses of Kaziranga National Park









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